



Luke Michaels

Web Designer & Developer

lmichaels@gmail.com : 503.890.0222 : lukemichaels.com : linkedin.com/in/lmichaels/

SUMMARY

Web designer and developer with 15+ years taking projects from research and design through to production code. I design interfaces in Figma, build them in React and WordPress, and I make the brand and graphic work that goes around them. Most of my career has been agency and nonprofit campaign work, shipping on deadline for teams that needed the result to hold up. Accessibility, performance, and systems other people can run without me are constants in how I work.

SKILLS

Web Development: HTML5, CSS3/Sass, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, React, WordPress (custom themes, ACF Pro, Gutenberg), PHP, Node.js, Git/GitHub, Core Web Vitals and performance, WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility

UX/UI Design: User research, usability testing, stakeholder interviews, journey mapping, wireframing, interaction design, high-fidelity prototyping in Figma, design systems and component libraries

Design & Brand: Brand identity, typography, color, layout, visual hierarchy, print and digital collateral, social creative, print production and color management (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Web Designer & Developer
11/25 to Present | Remote

- Design and build WordPress sites for nonprofit and small business clients, running each project from discovery and design through development and launch.
- Current contract: a full website for Voters For Animal Rights, a fixed-scope project I run end to end.

Senior Web Developer & UX Designer Mercy For Animals

09/17 to 11/25 | Remote / Portland, OR

Owned design and front-end development for a global advocacy nonprofit reaching millions of visitors a year, working across product, content, and program teams.

- Built and maintained a 100+ component design system and ACF Pro block library, with contribution standards and documentation, so non-technical staff could assemble campaign sites without a developer. Launches dropped from two weeks to three days.
- Designed and built responsive campaign sites and landing pages, translating brand and campaign concepts into finished, on-brand pages.
- Raised Core Web Vitals by up to 40% and moved mobile PageSpeed from the 60s into the 90s through code-splitting, asset optimization, and caching.
- Took public-facing properties to WCAG 2.1 AA and 95%+ Lighthouse accessibility scores with semantic markup, keyboard and focus handling, ARIA, and screen-reader testing.
- Ran design reviews and usability input with product, content, and leadership, turning research into the patterns the team built from.
- Designed campaign creative across web, social, email, and print, holding brand consistency across every surface.
- Built A/B-test-ready CTA components deployed across international campaigns, cutting deployment time about 50% and bounce rates 15 to 20% on key pages.

Front-End Developer & UX Designer

DHX Advertising

02/16 to 09/17 | Portland, OR

- Built responsive WordPress and Drupal sites from mockups for regional and national marketing clients, with reusable components and CSS animation.
- Designed brand-consistent marketing creative alongside copywriters and account teams.

Web Designer & Front-End Developer

Needmore Designs

11/15 to 02/16 | Portland, OR

- Designed and built accessible sites for boutique brands, with CMS setups non-technical owners could manage themselves.

Web Designer & Developer

Conscious Box

10/13 to 11/15 | Portland, OR

- Designed marketing pages, subscription onboarding, and email campaigns, and A/B-tested landing pages that raised conversion.
- Kept the brand consistent across web, print, email, and social.

Web Designer & Developer

Bob's Red Mill Natural Foods

04/11 to 10/13 | Milwaukie, OR

- Maintained and extended ecommerce across Magento, WooCommerce, and custom PHP for a high-volume consumer audience.
- Reworked navigation and checkout, and worked on SEO, server administration, and site performance.

Earlier Roles (2005 to 2011):

Web design, front-end development, print layout, and brand assets at agencies including Off The Wall Media, Print Time, LineDrive, and Title Boxing.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Night Lights (nightlights.club) |

Headless WordPress/WooCommerce, React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind

Ecommerce shop for my handmade interactive LED art and DIY kits. I designed the brand, built the store, and shipped it myself.

Personal Portfolio & Dashboard

(lukemichaels.com) | React, Framer Motion

Portfolio site and dashboard with a 100/100 Lighthouse performance score.

Nutty Narrows Thrift Shop (WIP) | React, TypeScript, Redux, REST API integration

Accessible informational site in React and TypeScript, with custom animations, page transitions, and global UI state in Redux.

EDUCATION

A.S. in Computer Science & Digital Media
Full Sail University | Orlando, FL

